

```
flasher-debian-7.5-2014-05-14-2gb.img.xz
```

After the image is downloaded, unzip it by using the following command:

```
$ xz -d BBB*.xz
```

In the above command, *BBB** denotes the full name of the downloaded image.

After unzipping the downloaded image, mount the SD card and copy the image on to it.

The command used to mount the SD card is given below:

```
$ sudo mount /dev/<Device name> E.g. sdb1
```



Figure 3: Command showing mounting of the SD card

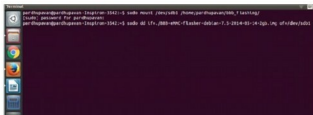


Figure 4: Copying the image to the SD card



Figure 5: After the SD card is inserted, the board starts to flash

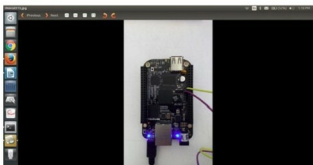


Figure 6: LED status after flashing

The above command is shown in Figure 3.

In this case, I have created a mount point *bbb_flasher* and have mounted the SD card. You can go to *Devices* to confirm whether the SD card has mounted properly or not.

I am going to use the *dd* command to copy the image file to the SD card. Figure 4 shows the image files being copied to the SD card, in my case.

```
$sudo dd if=/path/to/image/file of=/dev/<SD Cardname>
```

After the image has been successfully copied on to the SD card, unmount the SD card and insert it into the board, which is in the switched off state.

The command used for unmounting the SD card is as follows:

```
$sudo umount /dev/(Device name) Eg: sdb1
```

We have to provide an external power supply by holding switch2 on the board. The SD card present in the board functions and tries to flash the board, as shown in Figure 5.

As soon as the LEDs present on the board begin to flash, you can release switch2.

It may take around 45 minutes to one hour to flash the board. When the LEDs present on the board stop blinking and are ON, the board has been flashed completely. In the screenshot (Figure 6), we can see the LEDs glowing constantly after the completion of the flashing process.

As soon as the flashing is over, disconnect the power and try restarting the board by pressing the S2 button.

Finally, press S3 to power up the board and you will have the latest image installed on it.

Beaglebone Black is used in robotics, motor drivers, Twitter printers, data backups, SDR base stations, USB data acquisition and more. It offers great customisation, speed and MATLAB compatibility. It runs Simulink models as standalone applications and the off-course JTAG debugger. The incredible number of pins on the Beaglebone Black and the many bus options allow users to easily interface it with pretty much any device out there. [END](http://tiny.cc/1r5gh7o)

References

- [1] <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/BeagleBoard>
- [2] <http://derekmolloy.ie/>
- [3] <http://tiny.cc/1r5gh7o>

By: S. Pardhu Pavan

The author currently works at AdeptChips Pvt Ltd, Bengaluru, as an embedded systems engineer in the areas of communications and Internet enabled systems. He is an open source enthusiast, and has experience in C programming and device driver development.